

UNIT 2 / Numbers and identity

Countries and languages

Your goal: Say where you live, where you come from and which languages you speak.

01 Learn the idea

Separate origin from residence: Ich komme aus Indien describes where you come from; Ich wohne in Berlin describes where you live. A person can use both sentences together. Most cities and countries follow in or aus without an article, but learn exceptions such as in der Schweiz as whole expressions.

Language names include Deutsch, Englisch, Hindi and Spanisch. Use Ich spreche with a language and ein bisschen to describe a little knowledge. Sprechen changes its vowel with du and er/sie: du sprichst, sie spricht. At this stage, memorise the forms you need for introductions and practise them in context.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich wohne in Berlin.	I live in Berlin.
Ich spreche Englisch.	I speak English.
ein bisschen Deutsch	a little German
Wo wohnst du?	Where do you live?
Woher kommst du?	Where do you come from?

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Woher kommst du, Alex?

Where do you come from, Alex?

Alex

Aus Indien. Jetzt wohne ich in Berlin.

From India. Now I live in Berlin.

Mia

Sprichst du Deutsch?

Do you speak German?

Alex

Ein bisschen. Ich spreche auch Englisch.

A little. I also speak English.

Your real-life mission

Create a profile with three lines: origin, current city and languages. Ask an imaginary partner Woher kommst du? and Wo wohnst du?

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich wohne in Berlin.” mean?

- A. I speak English.
- B. I live in Berlin.
- C. a little German

2. What does “Ich spreche Englisch.” mean?

- A. a little German
- B. Where do you live?
- C. I speak English.

3. What does “ein bisschen Deutsch” mean?

- A. a little German
- B. Where do you live?
- C. Where do you come from?

4. Which question asks about origin?

- A. Wo wohnst du?
- B. Woher kommst du?
- C. Wie heißt du?

5. Where does Alex live now?

- A. Berlin
- B. Hamburg
- C. Munich

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. B - I live in Berlin.

“Ich wohne in Berlin.” means “I live in Berlin.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. C - I speak English.

“Ich spreche Englisch.” means “I speak English.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. A - a little German

“ein bisschen Deutsch” means “a little German”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - Woher kommst du?

Woher asks where someone comes from; wo asks about location.

5. A - Berlin

Jetzt wohne ich in Berlin gives Alex's current city.

One possible mission response

Ich komme aus Indien. Ich wohne in Hamburg. Ich spreche Hindi, Englisch und ein bisschen Deutsch.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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